Natasha Goel

CONTACT INFORMATION

Cornell University
Uris Hall, 243
Ithaca, NY 14853

E-mail: nsg82@cornell.edu
Website: www.natasha-goel.com

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Postdoctoral Associate, Cornell University September 2026–
Supervisors: David G. Rand and Gordon Pennycook

EDUCATION

PhD, Department of Political Science, University of Toronto 2021-2026
Dissertation titled *"Thinking About Thinking: Considerations on the Processing of Incongruent Information"*

Committee: Eric Merkley, Daniel Rubenson, James N. Druckman, Chagai Weiss (Internal reader), Kevin Arceneaux (External reader)

MA, Department of Geography & Planning, University of Toronto 2019-2020
Dissertation titled *"Residential Segregation and Inequality: Considering Barriers to Choice in Toronto"*

BA, Bilingual (French), Hons. Major/Minor Economics & Psychology, York University 2012-2017
Academic Exchange at L'Institut d'études Politiques (Sciences Po) Strasbourg, 2015-2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political psychology; Political communications; Survey and experiments; Computational social science; Public opinion; AI and politics; Digital media; American politics; Comparative politics

CITIZENSHIP

USA; Canada

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. **Natasha Goel**, Thomas Bergeron, Blake Lee-Whiting, Thomas Galipeau, Danielle Bohonos, Mujahedul Islam, Sonja Savolainen, Clareta Treger, and Eric Merkley. 2026. "Artificial Influence: Comparing the Effects of AI and Human Source Cues in Reducing Certainty in False Beliefs" [Accepted at *PNAS Nexus*]
2. Thomas Bergeron, Blake Lee-Whiting, and **Natasha Goel**. 2026. "Perceiving Politics: Considering the Political Categorization of Faces." *Journal of Experimental Political Science.*
3. Clareta Treger, Thomas Galipeau, Thomas Bergeron, Sarah Lachance, **Natasha Goel**, Mujahedul Islam, Blake Lee-Whiting, Beatrice Magistro, and Peter J. Loewen. 2026. "Political Party or Policy Position? The Role of Policy Partisanship and Party Cues in Voter Decision Making." *Polit Behav.*
4. **Natasha Goel** and Eric Merkley. 2025. "The Nature of Online Talk: Incivility of Opposing Views and Affective Polarization." *Polit Behav*, 47(4): 1483–1500.
5. **Natasha Goel**. 2023. "Residential Segregation and Inequality: Considering Barriers to Choice in Toronto." *The Canadian Geographer/Le Géographe canadien*, 67(3): 380-393.

UNDER REVIEW

1. Eric Merkley and **Natasha Goel**. "The Relationship Between Polarization Misperceptions and Partisan Hostility is Reciprocal" [Revise & Resubmit at *Political Psychology*]
2. **Natasha Goel**. "Motivating Demand for Corrective Information"
3. **Natasha Goel**. "Threat Primes Do Not Reliably Bias Immigration Information Processing"

Works in Progress

1. Gabrielle Lim and **Natasha Goel**. "Data Types and Government Access in Social Media Privacy Policies"
2. Helen Hayes, **Natasha Goel**, and Sequoia Kim. "Silencing Journalists: Attitudes Toward Journalist Harassment on Social Media"

Book Chapters

Helen Hayes and **Natasha Goel**. "Media Influence on Trust in Online Remote Voting." In *Trust and Trustworthiness: Evaluations of Online Voting*. McGill-Queen's University Press [*Under contract*]

Eric Merkley and **Natasha Goel**. "The Comparative Correlates and Effects of Anti-intellectualism in Canada and the United States" In *The Routledge Handbook of Anti-Intellectualism*.

Non-refereed Publications

1. Randy Besco and **Natasha Goel**. December 4, 2025. "Who Changed Their Minds? Two Shifts in Canadian Public Opinion on Immigration: 1995-2005 and 2023-24," *Institute for Research on Public Policy (IRPP)*.
2. **Natasha Goel**. September 2025. "Here to Stay: Understanding Immigrant Retention in Canada", *Institute for Canadian Citizenship (ICC)*.
3. **Natasha Goel**. June 26, 2025. "Can ChatGPT Change Your Mind? Perhaps, Studies Show", *Tech Policy Press*.
4. **Natasha Goel**. 2021. "From Crisis to Opportunity: Challenges Today and Futureproofing for Tomorrow," *Economic Blueprint Institute*.

Select Awards & Scholarships

Department of Political Science Special Opportunities Fund, 2026	*$1,000*
A. W. Johnson Graduate Scholarship, 2026	*$3,000*
Royal Bank Graduate Fellowship in Public And Economic Policy, 2025	*$8,000*
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (OGS), 2025-2026	*$15,000*
Department of Political Science Dissertation Research Funding, 2025	*$8,000*
Media Ecosystem Observatory Travel and Conference Award, 2024	*$1,550*
Media Ecosystem Observatory Research Fellowship, 2024-2025	*$18,000*
Munk School of Global Affairs & Public Policy Research Fellowship, 2023-2024	*$36,000*
Department of Political Science Summer Methods Funding, 2023	*$3,500*
SSHRC Canada Graduate Scholarship—Doctoral, 2022-2026	*$110,000*
Department of Political Science Doctoral Recruitment Award, 2021	*$6,000*
Joseph A. May Scholarship, 2020	*$1,000*
SSHRC Canada Graduate Scholarship— Master's, 2019-2021	*$23,300*
Department of Geography and Planning Entrance Award, 2019	*$5,000*

Teaching Experience

Course Instructor, Department of Political Science, University of Toronto

POL342H1: Topics in Methods I (Political Psychology)	Spring 2026
POL314H1: Public Opinion and Voting	Summer 2025

Teaching Assistant, Munk School of Global Affairs & Public Policy, University of Toronto

PPG2003: Capstone Course	Winter 2024, Winter 2025
PPG2018: The Role of Government	Winter 2023, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, Department of Political Science, University of Toronto

POL222: Introduction to Quantitative Reasoning I	Fall 2023, Fall 2024
POL218: State, Society and Power in Comparative Perspective	Fall 2022

POLB50: Canadian Government and Politics — Fall & Winter, 2021-2022

Teaching Assistant, Department of Geography & Planning, University of Toronto

GGR221: New Economic Spaces — Winter 2020

Research Assistance/ Fellowships

Research Assistant, Bridging Divides Project, Toronto Metropolitan University — 2025-2026

PI: Phil Triadafilopoulos (University of Toronto)

Fellow, Media Ecosystem Observatory (MEO), McGill University — 2024-2026

PI: Aengus Bridgman (McGill University)

Fellow, Policy, Elections & Representation Lab (PEARL), University of Toronto — 2022-2026

PI: Eric Merkley (University of Toronto), 2024-2026

PI: Peter John Loewen (Cornell University), 2022-2024

Research Assistant, Department of Political Science, University of Toronto — 2021-2026

PI: Eric Merkley (University of Toronto)

PI: Randy Besco (University of Toronto)

Conference Presentations

Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association (APSA) — 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP) — 2023, 2025

Annual Conference of the Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) — 2024, 2025, 2026

Annual Meeting of the Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA) — 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science — 2026 (Poster)

Toronto-Montreal Political Behavior Workshop — 2024, 2025, 2026 (Poster)

Urban Affairs Association (UAA) — 2022

Select Invited Talks

True Stories: News, disinformation + life in an unreal age, West End Phoenix — 2025

"Trust and Polarization," Symposium on Election Security and Emerging Threats, Tufts University — 2025

"Disinformation, Elections, and Democracy," POL 106: Contemporary Challenges to Democracy: Democracy in the Social Media Age, University of Toronto — 2024

"Public Trust in News in Canada," Trust Project Workshop: Growing News Audience and Trust, Globe and Mail Centre — 2024

School of Cities: Seminar on AI and the City, University of Toronto — 2024

Service

Peer review: Political Behavior, Journal of Information Technology & Politics, PNAS Nexus, Quality & Quantity, Social Media + Society, Information, Communication and Society

Founder of Women in Academia Mentorship (WAM) Network, Department of Political Science, University of Toronto — 2023–2026

Data Management Committee, PEARL, University of Toronto — 2023–2026

Comparative Politics Representative, Graduate Association of Students in Political Science, University of Toronto — 2023–2024

Additional training

Summer Academy on Large Language Models for Social Science, Columbia University 2026

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan 2025

Courses: Causal Inference for Social Sciences; Measurement, Scaling, and Dimensional Analysis, Machine Learning: Applications in Social Science Research; Multilevel Models I: Introduction and Application; Introduction to Python.

Skills

Software and Tools: R, Stata, Python, LaTeX, Qualtrics, Claude Code, Codex

Languages: English (fluent), French (intermediate)

Media Appearances

The Globe and Mail, CBC News Canada, Yahoo News Canada, Toronto Star

References

Daniel Rubenson, Professor of Political Science, University of Toronto

Eric Merkley, Assistant Professor of Political Science, University of Toronto

James N. Druckman, Professor of Political Science, University of Rochester

Nicholas Valentino, Professor of Political Science, University of Michigan